Ras Agez
Bi annual Newsletter of CoSAP
July to December 2024 issue No. 20 (Vol XX)

Message from the Secretariat

Dear Readers,

We are extremely pleased to share with you issue No.20 (VolXX) ‘‘Ras Agez” newsletter covering July to December 2024. Please forward your comments, suggestions and remarks to us at cosap.doc@gmail.com

Enjoy reading ‘‘Ras Agez”

Yosef Akalu
Director CoSAP

ACSO and CoSAP collaborated to empowering CSOs



A two round three days training were held in Adama from October 15 – 17 and October 23 – 25 2024, brought together about 100 staff members (24 female) from the Authority for Civil Society Organizations (ACSO) for an in depth learning experience. Jointly organized by CoSAP and ACSO with support from the European Union’s Civil Society Fund Plus (EU CSF+), the training focused on two vital areas of the Human Rights Based Approach (HRBA) and ACSO’s new legal directives for civil society organizations. The event created space for practical dialogue, critical reflection, and hands on capacity building marking a meaningful step forward in advancing rights based governance in the CSO sector in Ethiopia.



The sessions also introduced ACSO’s newly enacted directives, giving participants a clearer understanding of how the legal framework is evolving and what it means for compliance and reporting.

In his closing remarks, Ato Samson Biratu, stressed the need to strengthen CSOs’ capacity to work within the new legal framework while promoting human rights, and commended the ACSO and CoSAP partnership in building a more accountable and rights driven civil society sector. The Executive Director Yosef on his part highlighted CoSAP’s commitment to supporting grassroots and local CSOs to embrace the rights based approach for development as well as these organizations are informed of the new changes to remain vigilant on the CSO sector. The events were wrapped up with a certificate ceremony and a strong message, “building human rights driven civil society starts with shared learning, collaboration, and continued support.”

The 2024 Annual Learning and Sharing Forum Held



In a vibrant three days event held from December 25–27, 2024 at the Inter Luxury Hotel, Addis Ababa, CoSAP and its partners brought together model women from of Self Help Group (SHGs) member organizations, CSOs, donors, and government stakeholders for the 2024 Annual Learning and Sharing Forum. The gathering was a space not just for speeches and panels but for listening to impactful stories, hard truths, and future shaping conversations. The forum spotlighted transformative themes including digital financial inclusion for women, promotion of the rights of Female Domestic Workers (FDWs); youth led changes, and social enterprise for sustainability. The community leaders from SHGs and grassroots actors shared lived experiences.



Panel discussions brought together strong voices from EWLA, Andinet Female Domestic Workers Union, CVM, and Ministry of Labor and Skills, Ministry of Women and Social Affairs and other government offices, all pushing for policy reform, standardized contracts, and adoption of ILO Convention 189 to protect FDWs. A highlight was given on CoSAP's new SHG Digital App, developed with support from Kifiya Financial Technologies, with a vision to empowering over 300,000 SHG women to manage their savings and loans more transparently. Youth engagement programs, donor management insights, and CSO sustainability strategies rounded out the forum, with clear takeaways: local ownership, collective action, and bold advocacy are the way forward. As CoSAP Director Yosef Akalu noted, "We are not just building programs we are building possibilities."



Unlocking Opportunities for Women SHGs Through Uncollateralized Loans

Timret Lelewet Federation in Adama, Oromia explored opportunities for expanding financial access for women in Self-Help Groups (SHGs) under their network. The federation hosted a meeting among the leaders of the federation, Cluster Level Association (CLA) representatives, and CoSAP staff for a meaningful exchange on progress, challenges, and future directions.

One of the key highlights of the meeting was the opportunity for SHG members to access uncollateralized loans through a growing partnership with the digital finance solution. This financial model offers a promising solution to the longstanding challenge of collateral requirements that often exclude low-income women from formal financial services. With this approach, women organized in SHGs could access credit based on group solidarity and trust, not physical assets.





Participants also reflected on how such access to capital can help women start small businesses, strengthen existing enterprises, and contribute more significantly to their households and communities. So far, 476 women have accessed these loans and in the upcoming



Breaking Barriers to Champion Children with Disabilities

On December 6, 2024, the Community of Practice (CoP) for Safeguarding Children with Disabilities marked the 2024 International Day of Persons with Disabilities with a powerful panel discussion under the theme: "Amplifying the Leadership of Persons with Disabilities for an Inclusive and Sustainable Future." Held at Inter Luxury Hotel in Addis Ababa, the event brought together government officials, CSOs, Persons with Disability Organizations, Children with Disabilities, Educators, Police officials and the media.

The forum stood out for putting the voices of children with disabilities. Participants heard compelling testimonies, shared good practices in inclusive education and health, and called out long-standing challenges, from inaccessible school subjects to the lack of legal recognition for children's advocacy groups.



Members of the CoP, DEC and RAPID showcased their innovative inclusion models, such as a 6% - 10% disability inclusion benchmark in projects and government linked physiotherapy services.

The daylong session wrapped up with a collective message; "Diversity is strength, not a barrier." Stakeholders pledged action expanding sign language training, scaling disability friendly services in schools and health centers, engaging the media, and lobbying for policy reform. The moderator of the day and the renowned media influencer, Megabi Hadis Alemayehu Eshetu remarked that, "We can only achieve inclusive development by embracing diversity with purpose and endurance."

The Community of Practice (CoP) is a groups of 14 CSOs come together to learn and share experiences to safeguarding of Children with Disabilities. The CoP was established in 2023 as an informal grouping of CSOs with the generous financial and technical support of Kindernothilfe.

CSF+ Partners Kick Off Local Development Projects Across Oromia



Under the umbrella of the EU-funded CSF+ Local Capacity Development Program for Local and Grassroots CSOs (CDP-LG CSOs), three sub grantee partners have officially launched their projects across different parts of Oromia Region.



In Dukem town, Keabrak Charitable Organization (KCO), on November 18, 2024 held a launching workshop for its project aimed at empowering female workers in the Eastern Industrial Zone and supporting \marginalized women and youth. The event brought together government officials, community elders, Abba Gedas, Hada Sinque, community members and other stakeholders.

On October 24, 2024, The Network of Civil Society Organizations in Oromia (NeCSOO) has organized its launching event in Addis Ababa, introducing a year-long project focused on expanding civic space and enhancing collaboration between local CSOs in Oromia and development partners.





In Sagure town, Siinqee for Gender Equality in Social and Development (SGESD) launched its initiative to reduce labor exploitation among women, girls, and children in Digelu-Tijo Woreda by 15% during the 18 months project. The launch was held October 28, 2024 and attended by local authorities, education office, Hada Sinque, Aba Gada, and community members.

These initiatives are implemented by the respective organizations with financial support from the European Union Delegation to Ethiopia and managed by WHH, CoSAP and DEC.

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የትግስት ተስፋዬ የስኬት ታሪክ



ትግስት ተስፋዬ በሆለታ ከተማ በተለይም ቡርቃ ሀርቡ ቀበሌ ጎጥ 3 ነዋሪ ስትሆን ሶስት ልጆቿን ጨምሮ ከአምስት ቤተሰቧ ጋር ትኖራለች ። ከ2022 ጀምሮ ትግስት የቢፍቱ ጋናማ የራስ አገዝ ቡድን አባል ነች ። በየሳምንቱ 10 ብር መቆጠብ የጀመረች ሲሆን ያለማቋረጥ ቁጠባዋን ቀጠለች ። ትግስት ወደ ቢፍቱ ጋናማ የራስ አገዝ ቡድን ከመቀላቀሏ በፊት ቤቷ አጠገብ ድንች እና ጎመን በመሸጥ ቤተሰቧን ትደግፍ ነበር ፡ ፡ በዚህ ስራ ገቢዋ አነስተኛ ስለነበር ጊዜ እሷ እና ቤተሰቧ ሙሉ ቀን ምግብ አጥተው የሚውሉባቸው ቀናቶች ነበሩ ፡ ፡

ትዕግስት ቢፍቱ ጋናማን የራስ አገዝ ቡድንን ተቀላቅላ ለጥቂት ወራት ከቆጠበች በኋላ ለሦስት ወራት የሚቆይ የመጀመሪያ ዙር ብድሯን 2000 ብር አገኘች ። ብድሩንም የንግድ ስራዋን ለማስፋፋት ተጠቀመችው ፡ ፡ እንደ ቲማቲም ፣ ቀይ ሽንኩርት ፣ ነጭ ሽንኩርት ፣ ካሮት ፣ ቀይ ባቄላ ፣ ጎመን ፣ ድንች ድንች ፣ በርበሬና ቅመማ ቅመሞች በመጨመር አነስተኛ ስራዋን አሳደገች ። በመቀጠልም በሁለተኛው ዙር ለአምስት ወራት 5000 ብር በመበደር የአትክልት ስራዋን የበለጠ አስፋፍታለች ። በቅርቡ ደግሞ በሦስተኛው ዙር ሌላ 5000 ብር በመበደር ስራዋን በከፍተኛ ደረጃ በማሳደግ አሁን በተሳካ ሁኔታ ላይ ትገኛለች ።

እንደ ትግስት ገለፃ, ሀይወቷ እና የቤተሰቧ የኑሮ ሁኔታ በጣም ተሻሽሏል ፤ ሶስቱም ልጆቿ አሁን ትምህርታቸውን እየተከታተሉ ይገኛሉ ። ከዚህ በፊት በቀን አንድ ጊዜ እንኳን ለመብላት ሲታገሉና ሲቸገሩ የነበሩት ቤተሰቧ ፤ በአሁን ወቅት በቀን ሶስት ጊዜ ከመብላትም አልፎ ገቢዋ በከፍተኛ ደረጃ ጨምሯል ። አሁን በቀን 250 ብር ዕቁብ ትጥላለች ፡ ፡ በተጨማሪም ከቡድን አባሎቿ ጋር በየሳምንቱ 300 ብር ዕቁብ ትጥላለች ። በግል ቁጠባዋ ደግሞ በየሰምንቱ እስከ 100 ብር በባንክ ትቆጥባለች ።

በአጠቃላይ ትግስት ራስ አገዝ ቡድንን በመቀላቀሏ ሀይወቷን እንደለወጠው ትመሰክራለችራለች ። እውቀትን ፣ ግንዛቤን እና በራስ መተማመንን አግኝታለሁ ትላለች ። ስለወደፊት ሀይወቷ ተስፈኛ መሆኗን ፣ መለወጥና ማደግን እንደማታቆም ገልጻለች ፡ ፡ በራስ አገዝ ቡድን ዓይኖቿን ስለከፈተች እና እዚህ ደረጃ እንድትደርስ ስላስቻላት ልባዊ ምስጋና ታቀርባለች ።

Oromia SHG Federations Join in Strength to Advance Legal Recognition and Growth

A two-day workshop held in Adama town to strengthen the Oromia Network of SHG Federations. The workshop held on November 28 and 29, 2024 which brought together participants from Adama, Bishoftu, Jimma, Fiche, Batu, Holeta, and Addis Ababa. Its main goal was to build stronger relationships among SHGs, Communities of Practice (CoPs), and Young Female Leaders (YFL) by improving communication and promoting collaboration. Participants engaged in sessions focused on organizational capacity building, policy advocacy skills, and the legal recognition of SHGs. In addition, a brief awareness session was held to mark the 16 Days of Activism against Gender-Based Violence.

The workshop concluded with the development of action plans to guide future coordination and advocacy efforts within the SHG movement in Oromia.





Gareen Of Gargaarsaa Federeeshinii Oromiyaa Beekamtii Seeraa akka argataniif tokkummaa uuman

Woorkishooppiin jajjabeessuu tokkummaa Federeeshinii Garee Of Gargaarsaa Oromiyaa magaalaa Adaamaatti guyyaa lamaaf gaggeeffameera. Worshoppiin kun Sadaasa 19 fi 20, bara 2017 kan gaggeeffamee yoo ta'u, hirmaattota Magaalaa Adaamaa, Bishooftuu, Jimmaa, Fichee, Baatuu, Holotaa fi Finfinnee irraa walitti dhufuudhaan irratti hirmaataniiru. Kaayyoon woorkishoophichaa inni guddaan, walitti dhufeenya Garee Of Gargaarsaa, Gamtaa Waldaalee Hawaasaaf Hojjetu (CoP), fi Hoggantoota dubartoota dargaggeeyyii ta'an walquunnamtii fi hariiroo isanii fooyyessuu irratti akka cimaniif kan bu'uureffatedha.

Hirmaattotni leenjiiwwan ijaarsa dandeettii dhaabbilee, ogummaa imaammata dhiibbaa uumuu fi beekamtii seereqabeessummaa garee of gargaarsaa irratti akka si'ahinaan hirmaataniif kan irratti xiyyeeffatedha. Akkasumas, sagantaan hubannoo gabaabaa guyyaa 16f sochii mirga dubartootaa fi dhiibbaa saalaa irratti xiyyeeffannoon akka kennamuuf kan qophaa'edha.

Dhuma irratti, karoora guddina hojii fuulduraa Tokkummaa Federeeshinii Garee Of Gargaarsaa Oromiyaa keessatti qindoominnii fi dandeettiin dhiibbaa uumuu isaanii akka cimuuf sochii isaanii daran kan kakaasuu ta'uusaa irratti waliigaluun xumurameera.

Ras Agez" meaning "Self Help"

Is a biannual newsletter published by CoSAP.

This newsletter has been produced with the financial assistance of partners. The contents of this document are the sole responsibility of CoSAP and can under no circumstances be regarded as reflecting the position of our donors.

Special thanks to all our supporters listed who have invested significantly in our work this year.
We value your partnership.

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